



The Debating Club

Courtroom: The Mock Trials

About the event :

Courtroom: The Mock Trials is a dynamic event centered around courtroom debates, where participants enact as lawyers and present arguments for a given case under the jurisdiction. It's all about thinking quickly, speaking confidently, and making strong points to win your case. If you enjoy debating or want to experience the thrill of being in a courtroom, this event is perfect for you!

PRIZES:

Rs. 2000 : Best Memorial submission

Rs. 8000: Winner team

Registration Guidelines:

- Teams will consist of 4 members.
- Each participant will take on a designated role during the debate.
- Participants are required to fill out a registration form to secure their spot for the event. The deadline for submitting the form is **4th January**.
- Only one member from the team needs to complete the registration form, ensuring that the names of all team members are included in the form.

For any queries, feel free to contact:



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Rules and Guidelines :

- Teams must ensure smooth coordination and transitions between roles for effective presentation.
- A summary of case facts, issues, and background will be provided to each team.
- Summaries of relevant laws, statutes, and case precedents will accompany the case briefs.
- A glossary of specific legal and courtroom terms will be provided to maintain proper courtroom conduct.
- Only the provided case briefs, legal summaries, and glossary may be used during the debate.
- A panel of 3 judges will preside over the event, assessing each team based on structure, case knowledge, decorum, rebuttal effectiveness, and teamwork.
- Formal language and respectful conduct are mandatory.
- Judges will permit or deny objections as deemed appropriate. Excessive or disruptive objections may incur penalties.
- Teams must adhere to the allotted times. Exceeding limits may result in deductions.
- Formal attire is required to maintain the courtroom environment.
- Any further changes in the rules will be communicated on the day of the event.

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Judging Criteria :

- Argument Structure and Persuasiveness
- Case Knowledge and Legal Application (not based on the usage of legal terms, but on how effectively the provided elements are used)
- Courtroom Decorum and Professionalism
- Cross-Examination and Rebuttal
- Team Coordination

First Round :

- Each team of 4 participants must submit a memorial addressing the moot problem.
- Detailed guidelines on memorial structure, format, and content will be sent via email.
- Each team member will take on a specific role during oral rounds:
 - Opening Statement Lawyer: Introduces the case, establishes jurisdiction, and outlines the team's key arguments.
 - Main Argument Lawyer: Presents the core arguments in detail, supported by evidence and reasoning.
 - Legal Research Expert: Explains the legal precedents, statutory laws, and authorities relied upon in the memorial, connecting them to the case.
 - Closing Statement Lawyer: Summarizes the case, reinforces the key points, and delivers the prayer for relief.

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- Best Memorial Prize: Awarded to the team with the most outstanding memorial.
- Teams with outstanding speaking abilities, teamwork, and depth of preparation will qualify for the next round.

Second Round:

- Each team of 4 participants will handle various stages of case presentation and argumentation, with the following roles:
- Opening Statement Lawyer: Presents the team's position and outlines key arguments (3 minutes).
- Main Argument Lawyer: Develops the core arguments based on case facts and laws.
- Cross-Examination Lawyer: Conducts cross-examinations and challenges the opposition's points.
- Closing Statement Lawyer: Summarizes and reinforces the team's arguments in a final statement (3 minutes).
- Each team will have 3 minutes for the Opening Statement to outline their arguments, 13 minutes for the Main Argument and Rebuttal Phase to present key arguments, cross-examine the opposition, and rebut opposing points, and 3 minutes for the Closing Statement to summarize and reinforce their stance, making the total duration **25 minutes per debate**.

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